RAUSHAN ZHANDAYEVA

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

George Washington University, Washington, D.C.
Postdoctoral Fellow, Institute for Data, Democracy, and Politics, May 2026 - present
- PI: Ethan Porter

EDUCATION

George Washington University, Washington, D.C.
Doctor of Philosophy, Political Science, May 2026
- Fields: Comparative Politics, Quantitative Methods
- Dissertation:"Essays in Political Communication during International Crises: The Case of the War in Ukraine."
- Committee: Henry Hale (chair), Ethan Porter, Harris Mylonas

Master of Arts, Political Science, May 2023

University of Notre Dame, Notre Dame, IN
Master of Arts, Global Affairs, May 2020
- Specialization: Public Policy

Nazarbayev University, Astana, Kazakhstan
Bachelor of Arts, Political Science and International Relations, *cum laude*, June 2018
- Semester at California State University - Bakersfield, U.S. State Department Scholarship, Fall 2016

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Zhandayeva, Raushan. "Does Affective Intelligence Theory Generalize? Evidence from the Russia-Ukraine War". *American Journal of Political Science, Forthcoming. DOI: 10.1111/ajps.70099.*

Zhandayeva, Raushan. "Wartime Agendas: Issue Salience in Russian and Western Media Coverage of Russia's War on Ukraine". *Post-Soviet Affairs (2026): 1-41.*

Chapman, Hannah S., and **Raushan Zhandayeva**. "Elite Narratives and State Response to Kazakhstan's Qandy Qantar Protests". *Communist and Post-Communist Studies (2025) 58 (4): 184–198.*

Chapman, Hannah S., and **Raushan Zhandayeva**. "Public Opinion toward Russia's War against Ukraine: Investigating Wartime Attitudes in Kazakhstan and Kyrgyzstan". *Post-Soviet Affairs 41, no. 1 (2025): 1-24.*

Porter, Ethan, R. Bailey Scott, Thomas J. Wood, and **Raushan Zhandayeva**. "Correcting Misinformation about the Russia-Ukraine War Reduces False Beliefs but Does not Change Views about the War". *PLoS ONE 19, no. 9 (2024): e0307090.*

BOOK CHAPTERS

Zhandayeva, Raushan. "Human Mobility in Central Asia: Defining and Redefining Identity". *In Introducing Central Asia and the South Caucasus, edited by Erica Marat, 299–314. London: Routledge, 2026.*

BOOK REVIEWS

Zhandayeva, Raushan. 2024. "Slow Anti-Americanism: Social Movements and Symbolic Politics in Central Asia by Edward Schatz." *Central Asian Survey 43 (3): 441–43.*

IN PROGRESS

Porter, Ethan, **Raushan Zhandayeva**, Meet Daxini, Nina Ebensperger, Peng Wei, Xiaoke

Zhang. "Do News Feeds Affect Attitudes? An Independent Replication of the Meta Experiments". *Under Review.*

Chapman, Hannah S. and **Raushan Zhandayeva.** "The Ukraine Effect: Evolving Perceptions of Russia, China, and the West in Central Asia". *Under Review.*

Lenton, Adam and **Raushan Zhandayeva**. "Interests Trump Values: Differentiated non-alignment in the Russia-Ukraine War and Preferred Peace Settlements in India". *Under Review.*

Lenton, Adam and **Raushan Zhandayeva**. "The Enemy of My Enemy: Populism, Political Communication, and Perceptions of the Russia–Ukraine War in India".

Arbour, David, Abdullah Ateyeh, Alexander Coppock, Peng Ding, Avi Feller, Ethan Porter, Yamil R. Velez, Tom J. Wood, **Raushan Zhandayeva**. "Taking AI Ads Seriously, But Not Literally: The Effects of an AI Attack Ad and Its Correction During An Election".

Porter, Ethan, Thomas J. Wood, **Raushan Zhandayeva**."Stronger Than Fiction: Facts Change Beliefs More Than Misinformation".

Umanets, Valeria, Dima Kortukov, Dmitrii Kofanov, **Raushan Zhandayeva**. "In the Shadow of Communism: Political Responsiveness in Post-Soviet Kazakhstan".

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Zhandayeva, Raushan and Aliya Askar. "Kazakhstan's Ambitious Goals Must Include the Eradication of Systemic Violence Against Women". *Vlast.kz.* May 2024.

Chapman, Hannah and **Raushan Zhandayeva**. "Attitudes towards Russia's War on Ukraine in Kazakhstan and Kyrgyzstan". *PONARS Eurasia.* December 2023.

Zhandayeva, Raushan and Rachael Rosenberg. "Kazakhstan's Bloody January: Digital Repression on the New Silk Road". *Toda Peace Institute.* November 2022.

Zhandayeva, Raushan and Alimana Zhanmukanova. "Kazakhstan's Instability Has Been Building for Years". *Foreign Policy.* January 2022.

Khashimov, Sher and **Raushan Zhandayeva**. "Kazakhstan's Vibrant Alternative Media is Thriving - and in Danger". *Foreign Policy.* July 2021.

Simpson, Natalie, **Raushan Zhandayeva**, Sher Khashimov, Samuel Elzinga. "Revolution and Rising Discontent: An Update on the Central Asia Protest Tracker". *The Oxus Society for Central Asian Affairs.* January 2021.

Khashimov, Sher, **Raushan Zhandayeva**, Kymbat Nuranova, Zhibek Aisarina. "Introducing the Central Asia Migration Tracker". *The Oxus Society for Central Asian Affairs.* December 2020.

INVITED TALKS

"Beyond the Domestic Audience: Coverage and Sentiment in Russian and Western Reporting on the War on Ukraine", Opening the Black Box: Researching Russia Through Data and Digital Methods, Centre for data and research on Russia and NEST Centre, October 2026

"Computational Text Analysis of Russian-Language Media: Text-as-Data, Topic Modeling, and Sentiment Analysis", Russia Program - Digital Methods School, George Washington University, April 2026

"The Ukraine Effect: How Russia's War in Ukraine Reshaped Attitudes toward Foreign Powers in Central Asia" with Hannah S. Chapman, Jordan Center for the Advanced Study of Russia, New York University, March 2026

"Living Intersectionality in Academia: Emerging Scholars", Center for Russian, East European and Eurasian Studies, University of Pittsburgh, January 2022

"What is Happening to Kazakhstan", Royal Society for Asian Affairs and Oxus Society for Central Asian Affairs, January 2022

"A Week that Changed Kazakhstan Forever. What's Next?", Radio Free Europe/Radio Liberty, Twitter Spaces, January 2022

"What's Going on in Kazakhstan?", The Inquiry, BBC World Service, January 2022

CONFERENCE AND WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2024, 2026)

DC Area Postcommunist Politics Social Science Workshop (2023, 2026)

Workshop on Contemporary Ukrainian Politics, Petrarch Program on Ukraine, George Washington University (2026)

Association for Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies Convention (2022, 2025)

Association for the Study of Nationalities World Convention (2023, 2025)

Russia Program Conference, George Washington University (2024, 2025)

College of International Studies Symposium, University of Oklahoma (2025)

Midwest Political Science Association Conference (2022, 2024)

LAPOP Lab Summer School in International Survey Methods, Vanderbilt University (2024)

Graduate Student Conference for the Study of Europe and Central Asia, University of Pittsburgh (2019, 2023)

Graduate Student Conference on Central Asia, Harvard University (2023)

Graduate Student Research Conference on Eurasia in the Social Sciences, UNC-Chapel Hill (2023)

Comparative Politics Research Workshop, George Washington University (2022)

The European and Eurasian Undergraduate Research Symposium, University of Pittsburgh (2018)

RESEARCH ASSISTANCE

George Washington University
Dr. Ethan Porter, Summer 2023, Spring - Summer 2024
Dr. David Szakonyi, Summer 2021

University of Notre Dame
Dr. Susanne Wengle, March 2020 - October 2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, George Washington University
Politics of Information, Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant, George Washington University
Nationalism, Instructor: Dr. Harris Mylonas, Spring 2025
Intro to International Affairs, Instructor: Dr. Alex Downes, Fall 2023

Intro to International Affairs, Instructor: Dr. Michael Brown, Fall 2022, Spring 2023
Intro to Comparative Politics, Instructor: Dr. Bruce Dickson, Spring 2021
Intro to Comparative Politics, Instructor: Dr. Kimberly Morgan, Fall 2020

GRANTS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

Award for Best Instructor of Record, Department of Political Science, George Washington University, AY 2025-2026

Dean's Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Columbian College of Arts and Sciences, George Washington University ($14,150), Spring 2026

Dean's Graduate Lectureship, Columbian College of Arts and Sciences, George Washington University ($14,150), Fall 2025

Summer Fellowship, Institute for Data, Democracy, and Politics, George Washington University ($2,500), Summer 2024

PhD Student Fellowship, Institute for European, Russian, and Eurasian Studies, George Washington University ($2,000), Spring - Summer 2024

Visiting Scholar Fellowship, Jordan Center for the Advanced Study of Russia, New York University, September 2023 - August 2025

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods Grant, George Washington University ($3,500), July - August 2023

Travel and Accommodation Grant, UNLEASH Global Innovation Lab, November 2019

Professional Development Award, University of Notre Dame ($500), June 2019

Donald and Marilyn Keough Fellowship, University of Notre Dame ($73,600/year), August 2018 - May 2020

US Government Alumni Small Grants Program, US Embassy in Kazakhstan ($7,000), July 2018

Global Undergraduate Exchange Scholarship, US State Department ($20,000), August 2016 – December 2016

Fully Funded Government Scholarship, Nazarbayev University, August 2014 - June 2018

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer: *Journal of Politics*, *Science Advances*, *Post-Soviet Affairs*, *Nationalities Papers*, *Central Asian Survey*, *Communist and Post-Communist Studies*

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

New Era Workshop, Bridging the Gap, University of Denver, Denver, CO, October 2024

Summer School in International Survey Methods, LAPOP Lab, Vanderbilt University, Nashville, TN, June 2024

Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research, Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI, July - August 2023

SKILLS

Analytics: R, Python, Qualtrics, LaTeX, Stata, SQL, ArcGIS, Tableau
Languages: English (fluent), Russian (fluent), Kazakh (fluent), Spanish (intermediate)
Field Research Experience: Kazakhstan, India, Mexico
Certification: IBM Data Science Professional Certificate, Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models

REFERENCES

Henry Hale
Professor of Political Science and International Affairs
George Washington University
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Ethan Porter
Associate Professor of Media and Public Affairs and of Political Science
George Washington University
evporter@gwu.edu

Harris Mylonas
Associate Professor of Political Science and International Affairs
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